

An Act

ENROLLED SENATE
BILL NO. 1277

By: Alvord of the Senate

and

Hill of the House

An Act relating to employment benefits; amending 40 O.S. 2021, Section 2-417, as amended by Section 1, Chapter 309, O.S.L. 2024 (40 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 2-417), which relates to disqualification; modifying conditions for disqualification for certain benefits; specifying acceptable work search actions; updating statutory language; and providing an effective date.

SUBJECT: Employment benefits

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 40 O.S. 2021, Section 2-417, as amended by Section 1, Chapter 309, O.S.L. 2024 (40 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 2-417), is amended to read as follows:

Section 2-417.

SEEK AND ACCEPT WORK - WEEK OF OCCURRENCE DISQUALIFICATION.

A. An individual shall be disqualified to receive benefits for each week in which the individual shall have failed to do any of the following:

1. Diligently search for suitable employment at a pay rate generally available in that area of the state in keeping with his or her prior experience, education and training; or

2. ~~Make application for the minimum number of weekly work search efforts as required by the Oklahoma Employment Security Commission; or~~

~~3. Present oneself as an applicant for employment in a manner designed to encourage favorable employment consideration~~ Conduct three weekly search actions, or more if required by the Oklahoma Employment Security Commission based on economic or geographic factors.

B. Acceptable work search actions shall be determined by the Commission and shall include, but not be limited to:

1. Submitting a resume to an employer;
2. Completing and submitting a job application to an employer;
3. Attending and completing an interview with an employer;
4. Participating in a work-related networking event sponsored by the Commission such as a job club or fair, industry association event, or networking group;
5. Participating in reemployment services offered to the claimant by the Commission or any other state employment service;
6. Participating in a volunteer training opportunity likely to lead to paid employment;
7. Taking a civil service exam for work in a government agency;
8. Developing or uploading a complete resume in the state's employment service system for the purpose of obtaining employment;
or
9. Any other work search activities prescribed by the Commission.

~~B.~~ C. The requirements of subsection A of this section shall be waived if the individual has been summoned to appear for jury duty before any court of the United States or of any state. The waiver ~~will~~ shall continue for as long as the individual remains on jury duty pursuant to the original summons.

SECTION 2. This act shall become effective November 1, 2026.

Passed the Senate the 9th day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Passed the House of Representatives the 5th day of May, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

OFFICE OF THE GOVERNOR

Received by the Office of the Governor this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____

Approved by the Governor of the State of Oklahoma this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

Governor of the State of Oklahoma

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____

day of _____, 20_____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.

By: _____